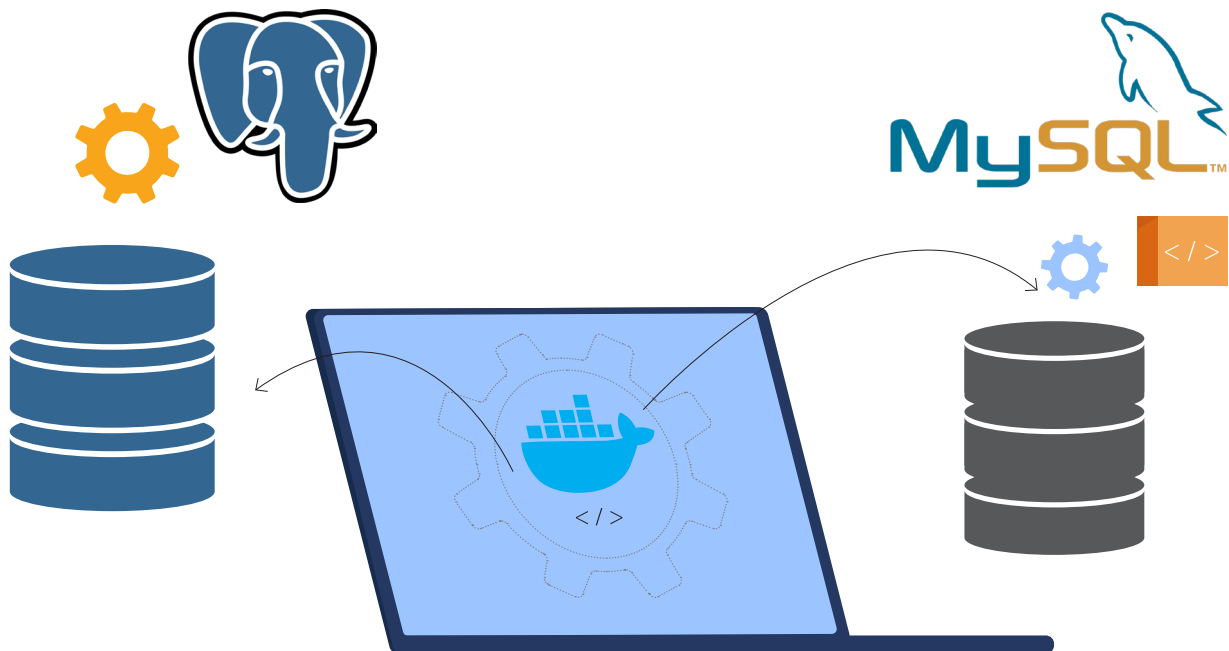


Using Docker to Experiment with Postgres and MySQL

Whether you are a student or a professional, as long as you are in the field of Web development, you'll always have to manage multiple database-powered projects in your computer at the same time, which is not an easy task. Docker offers a viable solution for this.



Think about installing an instance of MySQL or Postgres system-wide and then using it for all of your projects. You have to create databases and manage permissions for each project, and keep a track of the tables if you are sharing the default database among multiple hobby projects. You also have to perform manual clean ups occasionally. Worse still, you may find yourself struggling to log in as the root user and to reset passwords (if you haven't gone through this so far, just search 'mysql root password reset' and see how many complaints and totally diverse suggestions show up).

Is there a solution? Will containers help?

Why not use SQLite?

Sure, there's SQLite, in which a database is just a file, without any concept of server, users and permissions. That's why many use SQLite for local development and MySQL or Postgres in production. But this is practical only if you are using a framework with sufficient abstraction. Every RDBMS is incompatible with everything else in one way or another. The differences can vary from changes in syntax to the way transactions are carried out. So if you are planning for SQLite in production, use it in your dev environment.